

TAJWEED

Qur'anic Recitation — Lecture

Definition, Need, Importance & Basic Rules

Learning Objectives

By the end of this lecture, students will be able to:

- ❖ Define Tajweed
- ❖ Explain its need and importance
- ❖ Identify major articulation points (Makharij)
- ❖ Explain basic Tajweed rules with Qur'anic examples
- ❖ Apply the rules in recitation

Definition of Tajweed

- Tajweed is derived from the Arabic root جَوَّدَ, meaning “to make good, beautiful, or excellent.”
- Technically, Tajweed is the science of reciting the Holy Qur'an by pronouncing every letter from its correct articulation point (Makhraj) and giving it its proper characteristics (Sifāt).
- In simple words: Reading the Qur'an correctly, clearly and beautifully according to the rules of recitation.

Why Is Tajweed Important?

- Ensures correct pronunciation of Qur'anic words
- Helps preserve the words and sounds of the Qur'an
- Follows the Prophetic method of recitation
- Supports correct Qur'anic recitation in Salah
- Protects the intended meaning of words
- Makes recitation beautiful, clear and spiritually effective

Makharij al-Huruf

Makhraj = the articulation point from which a letter is pronounced.

Major areas:

- Al-Jawf — Oral cavity: letters of Madd
- Al-Halq — Throat: ع ه ح غ خ
- Al-Lisan — Tongue: ت د ط س ص ز etc.
- Ash-Shafatan — Two lips: ب م و ف
- Al-Khayshum — Nasal passage: Ghunnah

Example: ق — قُل and ل have different articulation points.

Noon Sakinah & Tanween

Four basic rules:

1. IZHAR — Clear pronunciation

Examples: مِنْهَا ، أُنْعَمْتَ

2. IDGHAM — Merging

Letters: ي ر م ل و ن

Examples: مَنْ يَقُولُ ، مِنْ رَبِّهِمْ

3. IQLAB — Conversion before ب

Example: أُنْبِئُهُمْ

4. IKHFA — Partial concealment with Ghunnah

Examples: مِنْ شَرٍّ ، أَنْفُسَكُمْ

Meem Sakinah

Three basic rules:

- Izhar Shafawi — Meem is clear before letters other than م and ب

Example: هُمْ فِيهَا

- Idgham Shafawi — Meem merges with the following Meem

Example: لَهُمْ مَا

- Ikhfa Shafawi — Meem is concealed before ب with Ghunnah

Example: تَرْمِيهِمْ بِحِجَارَةٍ

Madd — Prolongation

Madd means to prolong or stretch a sound.

Three basic Madd letters:

ا — Alif

و — Waw

ي — Ya

Madd al-Tabi'i (Natural Madd): generally prolonged for TWO counts (Harakat).

Examples:

قَالَ — فِيهِ — يَقُولُ

Ghunnah

Ghunnah is a nasal sound produced through the nasal passage.

It is especially clear in:

- Noon Mushaddad: نّ
- Meem Mushaddad: مّ

Examples:

نّ
مّ
نّ

Qalqalah

Qalqalah = a slight echoing/bouncing sound when a Qalqalah letter is in Sukoon.

Five letters:

ق ط ب ج د

Memory phrase:

قُطِبْ جَدَّ

Examples:

أَحَدٌ

يَجْعَلُ

يَقْطَعُونَ

Lam of Allah (الله)

The Lam in the word Allah may be heavy or light.

TAFKHIM — Heavy

When preceded by Fathah or Dammah:

قَالَ اللهُ

عِنْدُ اللهِ

TARQIQ — Light

When preceded by Kasrah:

بِسْمِ اللهِ

Rules of Raa (ر)

Raa can be pronounced heavy (Tafkhim) or light (Tarqiq), according to its vowel and surrounding letters.

Heavy examples:

رَبِّ

رَسُولُ

Light examples:

رِزْقُ

فِرْعَوْنُ

Quick Review

Tajweed = Correct Qur'anic pronunciation according to established rules.

Remember:

- Makharij — Where letters come from
- Noon Sakinah & Tanween — 4 rules
- Meem Sakinah — 3 rules
- Madd — Prolongation
- Ghunnah — Nasal sound
- Qalqalah — Echoing/bouncing sound
- Tafkhim & Tarqiq — Heavy and light pronunciation

Practice Activity

Read the following examples aloud and identify the Tajweed rule:

1. مِنْهَا
2. مَنْ يَقُولُ
3. أَنْبِئُهُمْ
4. لَهُمْ مَا
5. قَالَ
6. إِنَّ
7. أَحَدُ
8. بِسْمِ اللَّهِ

Task: Identify the rule and explain why it applies.

Conclusion

Tajweed enables us to recite the Holy Qur'an with accuracy, clarity and beauty.
Learn the rules — listen carefully — practise repeatedly — recite correctly.

Thank You

Important Exam Questions - Tajweed

1. What is Tajweed? Explain its need and importance in the recitation of the Holy Qur'an.
2. What are the major Makharij al-Huruf (articulation points of Arabic letters)? Explain with examples.
3. Explain the four basic rules of Noon Sakinah and Tanween: Izhar, Idgham, Iqlab, and Ikhfa, with examples.
4. What are the rules of Meem Sakinah? Explain Izhar Shafawi, Idgham Shafawi, and Ikhfa Shafawi with examples.
5. Explain Madd, Ghunnah, and Qalqalah with suitable Qur'anic examples.